

Guess the Meaning! - Idiom Quiz - A1/A2 Version

Name:

Date:

Bonus round - say it back

Read a short situation; students choose the matching idiom from the list of 8.

1. "You need to wait two minutes." **Hold your horses!**
2. "Nobody expected her to win, but she did!" **A dark horse**
3. "I sent my answer - now it's your turn." **The ball is in your court**

Companion file - the original guess-the-sport-idiom-quiz.md (8 rounds, sport-of-origin format) is unchanged and should still be used with B1-B2 students.

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Note for the teacher

The original quiz asks students to guess the **sport of origin** – that requires already knowing the figurative meaning *and* reasoning about where it came from, which is too many steps for true beginners. This version asks the simpler, direct question: **what does the idiom mean?** – with only 2 options, one clearly right and one clearly wrong.

How to run it

Read the idiom (with its emoji, if projecting), then give the 2 meaning options. Teams/ individuals guess before you reveal the answer. For Kahoot/Wayground, each row is one question: the idiom is the question text, the 2 meanings are the answer options, and the bolded one is correct.

#	Idiom	Option A	Option B	Answer
1	Hold your horses!	Wait!	Go faster!	A
2	Horsing around	Playing, being silly	Working hard	A
3	Get back in the saddle	Start again after a break	Stop forever	A
4	🐎 Champing at the bit	Very excited, can't wait	Very tired, bored	A
5	The ball is in your court	It's your turn now	The game is over	A
6	Game, set, match	It's finished / won	It's just starting	A
7	A slam dunk	An easy win, a sure thing	A big mistake	A
8	A dark horse	A surprise winner	The favourite, expected to win	A

About this activity

Companion to `guess-the-sport-idiom-quiz.md` – for A1-A2 students. Same 8 idioms as `sports-idioms-did-you-know-A1A2.md`. Ready to drop into Kahoot/Wayground as multiple choice, or run orally as a team game.